

The Camping Checklist

Tick the boxes on screen and save the file — or print it and use a pen. Both work.

SHELTER & SLEEP

- ☐ Tent, poles, pegs
Count the pegs at home, not in the dark
- ☐ Groundsheet or footprint
- ☐ Sleeping bag
Rated for the coldest night, not the average
- ☐ Sleeping mat
Insulation from the ground, not just comfort
- ☐ Pillow
A stuff sack of clothes works
- ☐ Mallet
- ☐ Spare pegs and 3m of cord
Weighs nothing, saves a night
- ☐ Tarp for the cooking area
Turns a wet weekend into a normal one

KITCHEN & FOOD

- ☐ Stove and fuel
Check the fuel fits the stove
- ☐ Lighter, plus matches as backup
- ☐ Pan, plate, bowl, mug per person
- ☐ Knife, spoon, spatula
- ☐ Chopping board
- ☐ Washing-up bowl, sponge, soap
Plan the washing-up before the menu
- ☐ Water container with a tap
Check if the site has drinking water
- ☐ Food, by meal not by guess
Write the meals down, then shop
- ☐ One no-cook meal
For the night you arrive late or wet
- ☐ Rubbish bags
- ☐ Coolbox and ice packs
Chill the box before you load it

CLOTHING

- ☐ Base layer — wool or synthetic
Not cotton next to skin
- ☐ Fleece or mid layer
- ☐ Waterproof jacket
Wash and re-proof it if it stopped beading
- ☐ Waterproof trousers
Also a windproof leg layer
- ☐ Warm layer for the evening
You sit still after dark — pack for that
- ☐ Hat and gloves
Even in summer, at night
- ☐ Spare socks — two pairs
The most forgotten item on any list
- ☐ Camp shoes
Something other than the boots you walked in
- ☐ Sun hat and sunscreen

LIGHT, TOOLS & SAFETY

- ☐ Head torch per person
One shared torch means three people in the dark
- ☐ Spare batteries
Keep them somewhere warm
- ☐ Lantern for the group
- ☐ First aid kit
Blister and burn cover matter most at camp
- ☐ Any personal medication
- ☐ Power bank, charged
- ☐ Offline map, plus a screenshot
A screenshot survives a dead signal
- ☐ Whistle
Carries further than your voice
- ☐ Multi-tool or knife
- ☐ Duct tape wrapped round a bottle

PERSONAL

- ☐ Toothbrush and toothpaste
- ☐ Towel
- ☐ Toilet roll
Never assume the site has any
- ☐ Hand sanitiser
- ☐ Insect repellent
- ☐ Sealed bag for wet or dirty kit

BEFORE YOU DRIVE OFF

- ☐ Someone knows where you are going
And when you are due back
- ☐ Booking confirmation saved offline
- ☐ Tent pitched once at home
Do not learn it in the dark, in wind
- ☐ Fuel, tyres, spare tyre
- ☐ Weather checked for the nights
Not just the days
- ☐ Local fire rules checked
Open fires are banned in many places

Want the whole trip covered?

This covers a normal camping trip. The full kit adds five trip-type chapters with their own lists, a spreadsheet that builds a clothing list from the forecast, and 89 printable Survival Cards for the day something goes wrong.

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